

Student Name: _____

Every essay is scored based on these criteria, with points assigned up to the maximum value awarded for each section. Only the very best papers receive the maximum score in most, or every, category. See also brief comments in the text of the paper, especially at the end. This paper is scored out of 100 total possible points and is worth 20% of your course grade.

1. Argument (20 pts) Does the paper focus on one central question that ties the paper together? Is this thesis a relevant archaeological question that is supportable using the scholarly sources cited in the essay?	
2. Use of Evidence (30 pts) Are at least three new sources referenced, and are the references chosen appropriate scientific sources? How closely are the multiple sources of evidence integrated analytically? Do these lines of evidence support the arguments presented by the author?	
3. Quality of Thought (20 pts) Does the essay demonstrate a clear understanding of archaeological evidence and the data types and scientific methods chosen? Are meaningful comparisons between diverse sources of evidence explored? Does the essay demonstrate insight or an original perspective on the topic?	
4. Organization (20 pts) Is the introduction focused around a clear thesis argument, with relevant background information and supporting arguments laid out in a logical and effective order, and a coherent conclusion?	
5. Style (10 pts) Does the essay fulfill the requirements of the essay as specified in the assignment, including structure, length, citation use and style, bibliography, page numbers, and title? Do the language, syntax, grammar, and vocabulary of the paper fulfill expectations for analytical writing at the college level? Has the paper been adequately proofread and spell-checked?	

Total score: _____